

AMERICAS ENERGY: OIL

US Majors: Screen for Attractive Valuation and Free Cash Flow Growth; Highlight 18% Total Return to COP (on Conviction List)

In this note, we update estimates for U.S. Majors (XOM, CVX, COP) ahead of 2Q26 earnings to reflect mark-to-market commodity prices and refining margins. Across the group, we monitor exposure to elevated crude prices, robust refining margins, and Middle East production risk. Amid the macro volatility, we look for management teams to maintain long-term plans for production growth, capital discipline, and shareholder returns. In particular, we highlight Buy-rated Chevron Corp (CVX) and ConocoPhillips (COP) for attractive risk/reward. Our structural view on CVX leverages a diversified, high-margin production profile tracking toward ~7-10% growth this year across the Permian, Kazakhstan, Gulf of America, and Guyana, with upside from exploration activities. This expanding portfolio, paired with capital discipline, should drive a ~10% average annual growth rate in adjusted free cash flow and earnings per share through 2030 at \$70/b Brent. For COP, major project start-ups and cost savings support a clear path to ~\$7 bn in free cash flow growth by 2029 at \$70/b WTI and a ~20-25% free cash flow per share CAGR through 2030. This growth should also drive strong shareholder returns through the cycle, around ~45% of cash flow from operations, while competitive positions in Alaska, Canada, and the Lower 48 offer OECD exposure against Middle East volatility. Please see within for further details.

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Majors Comp Sheet

	Rating	Price	Target	Dividend Yield	Return	Tot Ret	EV / DCF			ND / EBITDA			FCF / Equity Value		
		7/24/26	12 Mo.	%		%	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
		US Majors													
XOM	Neutral	\$158.32	\$164.00	2.6%	4%	6%	9.5x	10.2x	10.0x	0.2x	0.2x	0.2x	7%	6%	6%
CVX	Buy	\$196.51	\$225.00	3.7%	14%	18%	7.5x	8.6x	8.5x	0.2x	0.3x	0.2x	10%	8%	8%
COP	Buy	\$121.34	\$140.00	2.8%	15%	18%	6.6x	6.9x	6.9x	0.4x	0.4x	0.4x	8%	7%	8%
Average/Sum	--	--	--	3.0%	11%	14%	7.9x	8.5x	8.5x	0.3x	0.3x	0.3x	8%	7%	7%
EU Majors															
SHEL	Buy	\$88.77	\$111.00	3.4%	25%	28%	5.1x	5.2x	5.1x	0.6x	0.5x	0.4x	12%	12%	12%
TTE	Neutral	\$76.42	\$78.00	4.5%	2%	7%	5.2x	5.6x	5.7x	0.6x	0.6x	0.6x	10%	10%	10%
BP	Buy	\$44.23	\$52.00	4.5%	18%	22%	3.7x	3.9x	3.7x	0.4x	0.2x	0.1x	12%	12%	12%
EQNR	Sell	\$394.13	\$320.00	2.8%	-19%	-16%	4.0x	5.4x	5.4x	0.1x	0.1x	0.1x	12%	6%	6%
Average/Sum	--	--	--	3.8%	6%	10%	4.5x	5.0x	5.0x	0.4x	0.3x	0.3x	11%	10%	10%

Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

ConocoPhillips (COP, Buy)

- We continue to monitor a slate of growth projects, including NFE, Port Arthur, NFS, and Willow, that position the portfolio for higher production and cash flow. Following a successful winter construction season, the Willow project is now ~50% complete, keeping first oil on-track for early 2029 with the sea lift of processing modules serving as the next milestone. In the Lower 48, we look for updates on activity levels following plans to add a rig in the Permian to match ongoing completion efficiencies and higher levels of non-operated spend. Despite these positive project updates, we remain mindful of near-term earnings headwinds from soft Lower 48 natural gas realizations, which fell to ~24% of Henry Hub last quarter due to local Permian oversupply. On the upcoming earnings call, we also look for timing updates in the Middle East, where we believe our 2Q27 start-up for Train 1 of NFE skews as conservative.
- Management guides to 2Q26 production of ~2,185-2,215 MBOE/d, vs. GS at ~2,200 MBOE/d, which reflects the exclusion of Qatar volumes, adjusted Surmont royalty rates, and roughly ~20 MBOE/d of planned maintenance across Norway and the Montney.
- With respect to capital allocation, we note the company remains on-track to return ~45% of cash from operations to shareholders. While a lower capital returns payout last quarter drew some investor pushback, we expect this metric to normalize in future quarters. As a result, we estimate a total capital returns yield of ~7% in 2027/2028.
- Full-year capital spend guidance remains at ~\$12-\$12.5 bn, supporting incremental Permian activity over 2H26. We moderately adjust our capital spend estimates to reflect a more normalized roll-off profile, to ~\$12.0/\$11.7 bn respectively, for 2027/2028. In addition, we continue to highlight progress on cost reductions, with management confident in achieving ~\$1 bn in run-rate savings by year-end.
- We now estimate 2Q26 EPS of \$2.92 vs. FactSet consensus of ~\$2.89. On the earnings call, we expect management to discuss (a) Lower 48 production, (b) Alaska operations, (c) commodity price realizations, (d) capital spend levels, and (e) LNG projects.

Chevron Corp. (CVX, Buy)

- We look for further clarity around lower Kazakhstan volumes and disrupted CPC

flows, along with operational implications for Tengiz. We note the company exited last quarter with U.S. production over ~2 MBOE/d, Gorgon and Wheatstone LNG running at full rates, TCO production exceeding ~1 MBOE/d, and U.S. refineries operating at record crude throughput. Backed by these assets, management estimates ~7-10% total production growth this year. We also highlight strong Latin American exposure from upcoming project start-ups in Guyana and upside to volumes in Venezuela and Argentina.

- While Downstream earnings represent a smaller part of the total earnings mix, we look for shares to benefit from integration as management maximizes margins across products and optimizes flows to maintain high utilization and reliable supply into tight markets. In 2Q26, management expects global equity crude throughput to more than double year-over-year to 40%, alongside over ~80% refinery utilization in Asia.
- Over the long-term, we highlight a focus on strong free cash flow growth and capital discipline. At ~\$70/b Brent, management guides to ~10% average annual growth in adjusted free cash flow and earnings per share through 2030. The company expects long-term capital spend in the ~\$18-\$21 bn range, plans to repurchase ~\$10-\$20 bn of shares annually, and expects to save ~\$3-\$4 bn in structural costs by year-end.
- We also monitor for commentary on the use of AI/technology across the Permian, Gulf of America, and exploration areas. This follows a recently announced 20-year power agreement with MSFT for a co-located natural gas-fired power facility to provide electricity to a West Texas data center. Management expects the project to deliver 2.67 GW of capacity, using GE Vernova turbines and scaling via a phased, modular design. With FID later this year, we look for further color around capital spend and cash flow for the project, which targets mid-teen returns and first power delivery in 2028.
- We now estimate 2Q26 EPS of \$5.76 vs. FactSet consensus of ~\$5.53. On the earnings call, we expect management to discuss (a) international production, (b) U.S. activity, (c) capital allocation priorities, (d) exploration efforts, and (e) recent AI/power developments.

ExxonMobil (XOM, Neutral)

- We note the company's recent 8-K filing showed implied EPS of ~\$3.60 at the mid-point, excluding the impact of timing effects and identified items, with sequential improvement in Upstream, Downstream, and Chemicals from the previous quarter.
- Amid renewed Middle East escalation, we monitor the recovery timeline for two damaged LNG trains in Qatar. While Middle East operations account for ~20% of Upstream production, we estimate these trains represent ~3% of total output. Previous company guidance indicates that a full-quarter closure of the Strait of Hormuz would reduce the company's Middle East production by ~750 kbd vs. 2025, and lower global Product Solutions throughput by ~3% vs. 4Q25.
- Elsewhere in Upstream, we look for updates on proprietary Permian technologies, including lightweight proppant, to lift production to ~2.5 MBOE/d by 2030, with

full-year output tracking toward ~1.8 MBOE/d. In Guyana, management focuses on operational execution, reservoir optimization, unlocking acreage under force majeure, and preparing for Uaru start-up. In LNG, we expect final investment decisions for Papua New Guinea and Mozambique later this year, as well as further progress at Golden Pass, which reached first production this past spring. Meanwhile in Downstream, management looks to improve product yield and capture elevated global refining margins, supported by resilient demand.

- We note capital allocation strategy is unchanged, with guidance pointing to ~\$20 bn of share repurchases and ~\$27-\$29 bn of capital spend this year. In addition, the company continues to lead in cost efficiencies, guiding to a cumulative ~\$20 bn of structural savings by 2030 (vs. 2019). Potential M&A remains a key focus for investors given competitive Permian technologies and a premium multiple.
- We now estimate 2Q26 EPS of \$3.62 vs. FactSet consensus of ~\$3.61. On the earnings call, we expect management to discuss (a) advantaged Permian production, (b) LNG strategy, (c) exploration efforts, (d) Middle East impacts, and (e) M&A opportunities.

Valuation & Key Risks.

COP. We are Buy-rated on COP, and our 12-month P/E, EV/DACF, and DCF-based price target is now \$140 (from \$138 prior). We apply a target 13.5x P/E multiple and 7.5x EV/DACF multiple (both unchanged) on mid-cycle estimates. Our valuation blends an 85% fundamental value of \$137 and a 15% M&A theoretical value of \$160, derived by applying increased oil and natural gas price estimates of \$80/b Brent and \$3.75/MMBtu Henry Hub. Our 2026-2028 EPS estimates are now \$9.57/\$9.01/\$9.62 (from \$9.16/\$9.01/\$9.60 prior) to reflect mark-to-market commodity prices and adjustments to production, share repurchases, operating costs, and pricing realizations. Key risks relate to commodity prices, capital spend, and operational execution.

CVX. We are Buy-rated on CVX, and our 12-month EV/DACF, FCF Yield, and P/E-based price target is now \$225 (from \$216 prior). We apply a target 9.0x EV/DACF multiple, 15.0x P/E multiple, and 7.0% free cash flow yield (all unchanged) on mid-cycle estimates. Our 2026-2028 EPS estimates are now \$15.68/\$12.65/\$13.31 (from \$15.00/\$12.44/\$13.10 prior) to reflect mark-to-market commodity prices and refining margins, as well as adjustments to production, operating costs, and pricing realizations. Key risks relate to commodity prices, refining margins, and operational execution.

XOM. We are Neutral-rated on XOM, and our 12-month EV/DACF, FCF Yield, and P/E-based price target is now \$164 (from \$157 prior). We apply a target 9.5x EV/DACF multiple, 16.0x P/E multiple, and 6.0% FCF yield (all unchanged), on mid-cycle estimates. Our 2026-2028 EPS estimates are now \$11.37/\$10.24/\$10.63 (from \$11.96/\$9.98/\$10.51 prior) to reflect mark-to-market commodity prices and refining margins, as well as adjustments to production, refining utilization, operating costs, and pricing realizations. Key risks relate to commodity prices, refining margins, and operational execution.

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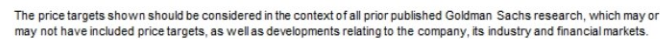
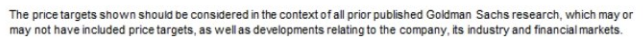
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Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
06-May-26	216.00	185.16
16-Apr-26	211.00	188.15
22-Mar-26	217.00	201.73
11-Mar-26	205.00	191.79
02-Feb-26	187.00	174.03
21-Jan-26	183.00	166.73
04-Dec-25	174.00	152.26
03-Nov-25	177.00	154.04
13-Oct-25	176.00	151.94
06-Aug-25	177.00	152.78
22-Jul-25	172.00	150.04

ExxonMobil Holdings (XOM)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
23-Jan-25	123.00	110.15
21-Nov-24	125.00	121.93
24-Oct-24	120.00	119.59
06-Sep-24	118.00	112.64
10-Jul-24	119.00	111.92
23-Apr-24	117.00	121.03
06-Feb-24	116.00	102.25
07-Dec-23	114.00	98.42
06-Nov-23	119.00	105.87
17-Oct-23	120.00	111.39
01-Sep-23	116.00	113.52
02-Aug-23	115.00	105.29

Chevron Corp. (CVX)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
07-May-25	174.00	135.79
17-Apr-25	176.00	137.87
27-Mar-25	186.00	166.65
04-Feb-25	183.00	153.22
16-Jan-25	182.00	159.38
06-Dec-24	174.00	155.24
21-Nov-24	170.00	161.63
24-Oct-24	167.00	150.45
06-Sep-24	169.00	138.56
26-Jul-24	177.00	157.84
17-May-24	175.00	162.67
23-Apr-24	176.00	162.85
30-Oct-23	180.00	146.09
17-Oct-23	192.00	167.59
31-Jul-23	187.00	163.66

ConocoPhillips (COP)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
29-Jun-26	138.00	104.20
22-Mar-26	144.00	126.92
11-Mar-26	135.00	117.03
27-Feb-26	125.00	113.46
06-Feb-26	120.00	107.62
21-Jan-26	115.00	97.15
16-Oct-25	108.00	86.91
23-Jul-25	111.00	95.04
09-May-25	119.00	88.59
17-Apr-25	121.00	88.98
27-Mar-25	126.00	102.82
07-Feb-25	128.00	98.36
29-Jan-25	132.00	101.56
13-Nov-24	130.00	111.82
24-Oct-24	125.00	104.37
06-Sep-24	127.00	106.02
24-Jun-24	130.00	115.17
09-Feb-24	134.00	111.16
16-Jan-24	135.00	108.64
03-Nov-23	138.00	119.75
17-Oct-23	135.00	125.46
14-Sep-23	130.00	124.50
07-Aug-23	128.00	114.48

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